Health Tech Regulatory & Compliance Analyst Roadmap Action Kit

Portfolio templates, interview questions, resume formulas, and your 90-day execution plan.

What is inside this kit:

1. 90-Day Execution Plan with weekly milestones
2. Portfolio Project Templates with starter prompts
3. Resume Bullet Formulas that translate your clinical experience
4. Interview Preparation Questions specific to this role
5. Resource Checklist with direct links

Difficulty: Moderate | Timeline: 4 to 8 months | Last Updated: 2026-03-24

Built by a pharmacist who made the switch. roadmaps.tarvra.com

1. Your 90-Day Execution Plan

This plan breaks the learning path into weekly milestones. Adjust the pace to fit your schedule, but try to maintain momentum. Consistency matters more than speed.

Phase 1: Regulatory Foundations

Duration: 1 to 8 **Effort:** 80 to 120

Week	Focus Area	Done?
Week 1	FDA Medical Device Regulatory Framework (510(k), De Novo, PMA pathways)	[ ]
Week 2	Software as a Medical Device (SaMD) classification and regulation	[ ]
Week 3	HIPAA Privacy and Security Rule deep dive	[ ]
Week 4	Quality Management System fundamentals (ISO 13485)	[ ]

✓ **Phase Checkpoint:** Map the regulatory pathway for a hypothetical AI-powered clinical decision support tool. Determine whether it qualifies as a medical device under FDA guidance, identify the appropriate submission pathway, and document the key regulatory requirements.

Phase 2: Compliance Systems and Standards

Duration: 8 to 20 **Effort:** 100 to 140

Week	Focus Area	Done?
Week 5	Quality Management Systems (QMS) implementation and auditing	[ ]
Week 6	Risk Management for Medical Devices (ISO 14971)	[ ]
Week 7	Software Lifecycle Processes (IEC 62304)	[ ]
Week 8	AI/ML Regulatory Frameworks (FDA PCCP guidance, EU AI Act basics)	[ ]

✓ **Phase Checkpoint:** Complete a mock regulatory submission package for an AI-enabled health tech product. Include risk analysis (ISO 14971), software documentation (IEC 62304), design control records, and a cybersecurity plan. Present the package as a portfolio deliverable.

Phase 3: Specialization and Practice

Duration: 20 to 32 **Effort:** 60 to 100

Week	Focus Area	Done?
Week 9	Track A: SaMD and AI/ML Device Regulation (FDA PCCP, predetermined change con...	[ ]
Week 10	Track B: Healthcare Privacy and Data Governance (HIPAA compliance programs, s...	[ ]
Week 11	Track C: Clinical Investigation and Evidence (IDE submissions, clinical study...	[ ]
Week 12	Track D: International Regulatory Strategy (EU MDR, EU AI Act, Health Canada,...	[ ]

✓ **Phase Checkpoint:** Complete two specialization projects: (1) a regulatory gap analysis for an existing health tech product against current FDA guidance and (2) a compliance program design or international regulatory strategy comparison. Both become portfolio deliverables.

2. Portfolio Project Templates

Each template gives you the project brief, tools needed, and starter prompts to begin immediately. Your clinical background is your competitive advantage.

Project 1: FDA SaMD Regulatory Pathway Analysis

Time Estimate: 4 to 6 weeks

Select a real AI-enabled health tech product (or design a hypothetical one). Determine its SaMD classification using the IMDRF framework, identify the correct FDA submission pathway (510(k), De Novo, or PMA), and create a regulatory strategy document with timeline and key milestones.

Tools: FDA Guidance Documents, IMDRF Framework, Regulatory Strategy Template

Dataset: FDA AI/ML-Enabled Medical Device Database

✓ **Your Clinical Advantage:** You can evaluate whether the product's intended clinical use is realistic and whether the regulatory claims align with actual clinical workflows

Starter Prompts (begin with these questions):

- What specific problem does this project solve for clinicians or patients?
- What data would I need, and what are the realistic constraints on getting it?
- How would I measure whether my solution actually works in a clinical setting?
- What would a hiring manager want to see in my write-up of this project?

Project 2: HIPAA Compliance Program Design

Time Estimate: 5 to 7 weeks

Design a comprehensive HIPAA compliance program for a digital health startup. Include risk assessment methodology, policies and procedures, training requirements, breach notification protocols, and Business Associate Agreement templates.

Tools: NIST Cybersecurity Framework, HHS HIPAA Resources, Risk Assessment Templates

Dataset: HHS Breach Portal (Wall of Shame)

✓ **Your Clinical Advantage:** You understand which PHI touchpoints create the highest risk because you have worked with patient data at the point of care

Starter Prompts (begin with these questions):

- What specific problem does this project solve for clinicians or patients?
- What data would I need, and what are the realistic constraints on getting it?
- How would I measure whether my solution actually works in a clinical setting?
- What would a hiring manager want to see in my write-up of this project?

Project 3: AI/ML Device Predetermined Change Control Plan (PCCP)

Time Estimate: 4 to 6 weeks

Create a PCCP for a hypothetical AI-enabled clinical decision support tool. Document the modification protocol, performance monitoring plan, update validation methodology, and transparency requirements per FDA guidance.

Tools: FDA PCCP Guidance, ISO 14971 Risk Management, IEC 62304 Software Lifecycle

Dataset: FDA PCCP Guidance and authorized AI/ML devices list

> ✓ **Your Clinical Advantage:** You can assess whether proposed AI model changes could create clinical safety risks that technical teams might underestimate

Starter Prompts (begin with these questions):

- What specific problem does this project solve for clinicians or patients?
- What data would I need, and what are the realistic constraints on getting it?
- How would I measure whether my solution actually works in a clinical setting?
- What would a hiring manager want to see in my write-up of this project?

Project 4: Regulatory Gap Analysis: Existing Health Tech Product

Time Estimate: 3 to 5 weeks

Select a commercially available health tech product and perform a regulatory gap analysis against current FDA requirements. Identify compliance gaps, prioritize risks, and propose a remediation plan with timeline and resource estimates.

Tools: FDA MAUDE Database, 510(k) Database, Gap Analysis Framework

Dataset: FDA 510(k) Database and MAUDE adverse event database

✓ **Your Clinical Advantage:** Your clinical experience helps you identify gaps that matter most for patient safety, not just technical compliance

Starter Prompts (begin with these questions):

- What specific problem does this project solve for clinicians or patients?
- What data would I need, and what are the realistic constraints on getting it?
- How would I measure whether my solution actually works in a clinical setting?
- What would a hiring manager want to see in my write-up of this project?

Project 5: International Regulatory Strategy Comparison

Time Estimate: 5 to 7 weeks

For a hypothetical digital health product, compare the regulatory requirements and timelines for market entry in the US (FDA), EU (EU MDR + EU AI Act), Canada (Health Canada), and UK (MHRA). Deliver a market entry strategy recommendation.

Tools: FDA Guidance, EU MDR Text, EU AI Act, Health Canada MDR

Dataset: Regulatory agency databases and guidance documents

✓ **Your Clinical Advantage:** Your understanding of clinical practice variations across countries adds depth to regulatory strategy that purely legal analysis misses

Starter Prompts (begin with these questions):

- What specific problem does this project solve for clinicians or patients?
- What data would I need, and what are the realistic constraints on getting it?
- How would I measure whether my solution actually works in a clinical setting?
- What would a hiring manager want to see in my write-up of this project?

3. Resume Bullet Formulas

Use these formulas to translate your clinical experience into language hiring managers recognize. Each formula follows the pattern: Clinical Skill translated to Tech Equivalent with context.

For Nurses

Clinical: Patient safety event reporting and root cause analysis	**Translates to:** Post-market surveillance and adverse event documentation (FDA MDR/MedWatch)

How to frame it: You already investigate safety events systematically; this becomes tracking and reporting device-related adverse events to regulatory bodies

Clinical: Joint Commission survey preparation and accreditation compliance	**Translates to:** Quality Management System (QMS) auditing and ISO 13485 compliance

How to frame it: Preparing for accreditation surveys is structurally identical to preparing for FDA quality system inspections

Clinical: Clinical protocol adherence and documentation standards	**Translates to:** Design control documentation and regulatory submission preparation

How to frame it: Your discipline around following clinical protocols transfers to maintaining design history files and technical documentation

Clinical: HIPAA awareness in daily clinical workflows	**Translates to:** Privacy impact assessments and HIPAA compliance program management

How to frame it: You have lived HIPAA requirements at the point of care; now you build and audit the systems that enforce them

Clinical: Medication administration safety checks (five rights)	**Translates to:** Risk management and failure mode analysis for health tech products

How to frame it: Systematic safety verification becomes product risk analysis using frameworks like ISO 14971

Clinical: Interdisciplinary care coordination and communication	**Translates to:** Cross-functional regulatory strategy across engineering, clinical, and legal teams

How to frame it: Navigating diverse clinical teams prepares you for coordinating regulatory requirements across product, engineering, and legal stakeholders

For Pharmacists

Clinical: DEA controlled substance compliance and state board regulations	**Translates to:** Multi-jurisdictional regulatory compliance and submission management

How to frame it: Navigating overlapping federal, state, and DEA requirements is the same skill as managing FDA, EU MDR, and international regulatory landscapes

Clinical: Drug safety monitoring and adverse drug reaction reporting	**Translates to:** Pharmacovigilance systems and post-market safety surveillance

How to frame it: ADR monitoring translates directly to medical device vigilance reporting and post-market clinical follow-up

Clinical: Formulary review and drug monograph evaluation	**Translates to:** Regulatory submission review and clinical evidence evaluation

How to frame it: Evaluating drug evidence for formulary decisions uses the same critical appraisal skills needed to assess regulatory submission quality

Clinical: Pharmacy and Therapeutics committee participation	**Translates to:** Regulatory advisory boards and standards committee participation

How to frame it: Presenting evidence-based recommendations to P&T; committees mirrors presenting regulatory strategies to executive leadership

Clinical: FDA REMS programs and medication safety protocols	**Translates to:** FDA Risk Evaluation and Mitigation Strategy design for health tech products

How to frame it: Direct experience with REMS gives you a foundation few non-pharmacists have in regulatory risk management

Clinical: Clinical trial drug management and protocol compliance	**Translates to:** Clinical investigation regulatory submissions (IDE applications, clinical study design review)

How to frame it: Managing investigational drugs teaches you the regulatory infrastructure that governs clinical evidence generation

For Other Clinicians

Clinical: Evidence-based practice and clinical guideline evaluation	**Translates to:** Clinical evidence assessment for regulatory submissions (510(k), De Novo, PMA)

How to frame it: Evaluating whether clinical evidence supports a practice change uses the same rigor as evaluating whether evidence supports a regulatory claim

Clinical: Clinical documentation and medical record standards	**Translates to:** Technical documentation standards (IEC 62304, ISO 13485 documentation requirements)

How to frame it: Meticulous clinical documentation habits prepare you for the documentation-intensive regulatory environment

Clinical: Quality improvement projects (PDSA cycles, Lean Six Sigma)	**Translates to:** Corrective and Preventive Action (CAPA) processes and continuous improvement

How to frame it: QI methodology is structurally identical to the CAPA processes required by FDA quality system regulations

Clinical: Informed consent processes and patient rights	**Translates to:** Human subjects protection and clinical investigation ethics (IRB submissions)

How to frame it: Understanding informed consent gives you the ethical foundation for navigating clinical study regulatory requirements

Clinical: Diagnostic reasoning and evidence evaluation	**Translates to:** Clinical validation study design and performance evaluation

How to frame it: Your ability to assess diagnostic accuracy translates to evaluating clinical performance claims for AI-enabled devices

Resume Bullet Template:
[Action verb] + [what you did in clinical terms] + [translated to tech impact] + [quantified result if possible]

Example: "Designed and maintained medication safety dashboards tracking 12,000+ monthly dispensing events, reducing near-miss medication errors by identifying data anomalies in real-time reporting workflows."

4. Interview Preparation Questions

Technical Questions

Q1: Walk me through the FDA's SaMD classification framework. How would you classify an AI-powered sepsis prediction tool?

Your answer notes:

Q2: What is the difference between a 510(k), De Novo, and PMA submission? When would you recommend each?

Your answer notes:

Q3: Explain the Predetermined Change Control Plan (PCCP) framework. How does it apply to AI/ML devices that learn over time?

Your answer notes:

Q4: How would you design a post-market surveillance plan for a clinical decision support tool deployed across 50 hospitals?

Your answer notes:

Q5: What are the key differences between ISO 13485 and FDA 21 CFR Part 820, and how does the 2026 QMSR update change things?

Your answer notes:

Behavioral Questions

Q1: Tell me about a time your clinical background helped you identify a regulatory risk that a legal-only team would have missed.

Your answer notes:

Q2: How do you handle a situation where engineering wants to ship a feature quickly but you believe it requires a new regulatory submission?

Your answer notes:

Q3: Describe how you would build relationships with both clinical and engineering teams as a regulatory professional.

Your answer notes:

Q4: How do you stay current with evolving FDA guidance and international regulations?

Your answer notes:

Scenario Questions

Q1: Your company receives an FDA 483 observation citing inadequate design controls. What is your immediate response plan?

Your answer notes:

Q2: A competitor's AI device was recalled for algorithmic bias. Your CEO asks whether your product has the same risk. How do you assess and respond?

Your answer notes:

Q3: You discover that a software update was deployed without going through the change control process. What do you do?

Your answer notes:

5. Resource Checklist

Every resource mentioned in the roadmap, organized by learning phase. Check them off as you complete each one.

Phase 1: Regulatory Foundations

Done ?	Resource	Type	Link
[ ]	FDA Digital Health Center of Excellence	FREE	https://www.fda.gov/medical-devices/digital-h...
[ ]	FDA SaMD Guidance Documents	FREE	https://www.fda.gov/medical-devices/digital-h...
[ ]	HHS HIPAA for Professionals	FREE	https://www.hhs.gov/hipaa/for-professionals/i...
[ ]	IMDRF SaMD Framework	FREE	https://www.imdrf.org/documents/software-medi...
[ ]	FDA Learning Portal	FREE	https://www.fda.gov/training-and-continuing-e...
[ ]	RAPS Regulatory Fundamentals Course	PAID	https://www.raps.org/education
[ ]	Coursera Regulatory Affairs Specialization	PAID	https://www.coursera.org

Phase 2: Compliance Systems and Standards

Done ?	Resource	Type	Link
[ ]	FDA Quality System Regulation (21 CFR Part 820)	FREE	https://www.ecfr.gov/current/title-21/chapter...
[ ]	FDA AI/ML-Based SaMD Action Plan	FREE	https://www.fda.gov/medical-devices/software-...
[ ]	NIST AI Risk Management Framework	FREE	https://www.nist.gov/artificial-intelligence
[ ]	FDA Cybersecurity Guidance	FREE	https://www.fda.gov/medical-devices/digital-h...
[ ]	Greenlight Guru Academy	FREE	https://www.greenlight.guru/academy
[ ]	ASQ Certified Quality Auditor Resources	PAID	https://asq.org/cert/quality-auditor

[ ]	Udemy ISO 13485 QMS Implementation	PAID	https://www.udemy.com

Phase 3: Specialization and Practice

Done ?	Resource	Type	Link
[ ]	FDA Predetermined Change Control Plan Guidance	FREE	https://www.fda.gov/regulatory-information/se...
[ ]	EU AI Act Official Text	FREE	https://artificialintelligenceact.eu
[ ]	HCCA Healthcare Compliance Resources	FREE	https://www.hcca-info.org
[ ]	ClinicalTrials.gov	FREE	https://clinicaltrials.gov
[ ]	RAPS RAC Exam Preparation	PAID	https://www.raps.org/rac
[ ]	HCCA CHC Certification Preparation	PAID	https://www.hcca-info.org/certification/becom...

What to do next:

1. Take the Career Quiz to confirm this role fits you: quiz.ehoneahobed.com
2. Subscribe to The Transmutation for weekly insights: thetransmutation.substack.com
3. Complete Move 1 from your roadmap today. It takes less than 3 hours.